

STANDARD LOGO DESIGN FILE FORMATS EXPLAINED

ADOBE ILLUSTRATOR (AI)



Native Adobe Illustrator source file format. The industry preferred, standard vector drawing program used by designers and commercial printers to generate files of different file formats and sizes. Since Illustrator image files are saved in a vector format, they can be enlarged without losing any image quality. Some third-party programs can open AI files, but may rasterize the image, meaning the vector data will be converted to bitmap format.

ENCAPSULATED POSTSCRIPT (EPS)



Encapsulated PostScript (EPS) language file format can contain both vector and bitmap graphics (raster) and is supported by virtually all graphic, illustration, and page layout programs. The EPS format is used to transfer PostScript-language artwork between applications. EPS files are the preferred format for design professionals to transfer an image or artwork into another application. Vector files are scalable to any size without degradation since the image software uses a mathematical technique called vectoring to create the image.

SCALABLE VECTOR GRAPHICS (SVG)



Scalable Vector Graphics are an XML based markup that can contain two-dimensional vectors. The vectors can be simple shapes, paths, or well just about anything you can do in Illustrator. It's an image format that has more in common with a web page than it does with a JPEG. SVG is much more powerful than other image formats we can use on the web as we can manipulate them with code (either in our text editor or with CSS / JS).

ADOBE PHOTOSHOP DOCUMENT (PSD)



PSD is the native Adobe PhotoShop file format and industry standard bitmap graphics program used by professional designers and printers. This file format is popular as it can be read by both Macintosh and Windows computers. For a logo to be used across a large spectrum of uses and applications, it must be created as a vector file. A common misconception is that the PSD is the master editable file source, but this is not true for logo design. PSDs are typically raster files made up of tiny dots, that when enlarged or reduced significantly in size, lose quality.

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PORTABLE DOCUMENT FORMAT (PDF)

PDF is an open source, universal file format developed by Adobe Systems that preserves and embeds fonts, images, layouts and both vector and bitmap graphics of any source document. PDF files can be shared, viewed and printed by anyone with the free Adobe Reader software. Some PDF files can be used for commercial, digital, and/or desktop printing.



JOINT PHOTOGRAPHIC EXPERTS GROUP (JPG OR JPEG)

JPEG or JPG is a standard format allowing the transfer of files between a wide variety of platforms, using superior compression techniques. The JPG does not support a transparent background, and the level of compression can vary in resolution with high-quality for desktop printing, medium quality for web viewing and low quality for email. When compressed repeatedly the overall quality of a JPG image is reduced. JPEG format supports CMYK, RGB, and Grayscale color modes, but does not support alpha channels.



PORTABLE NETWORK GRAPHICS (PNG)

PNG files are high-quality bitmap images that employ lossless data compression. PNG was created to improve upon and replace Graphics Interchange Format (GIF) as an image file format not requiring a patent license. PNG was designed for transferring images on the Internet, not for professional-quality print graphics, and thus does not support non-RGB color spaces such as CMYK. Unlike GIF, PNG supports 24-bit images and produces background transparency without jagged edges; however, some Web browsers do not support PNG images.



FAVICON (PNG OR ICO)

A favicon is the little icon that browsers display next to a page's title on a browser tab, or in the address bar next to its URL. It also is used when you bookmark a page. These are small square images usually 16×16 pixels which are used by web browsers to show a graphical representation of the site being visited at the left side of the browser's address bar. You have probably seen many favicons before, even if you don't know what they are. If there's any doubt, the image below will help.

